

Community waiting list within 18 weeks

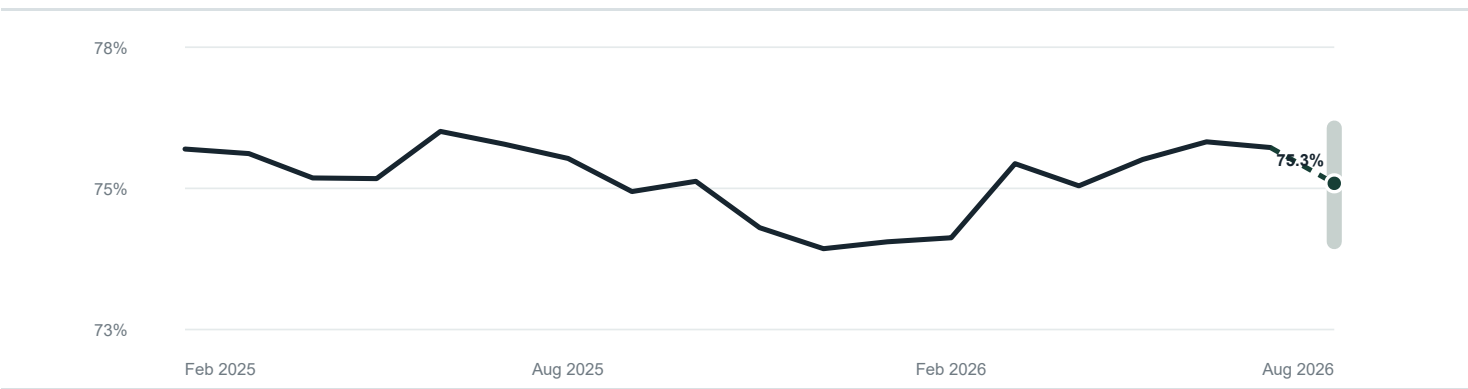
Forecast for August 2026 · data through July 2026

Community waiting list within 18 weeks is forecast to deteriorate at the next release, from 75.9% to 75.3%. The model's expected deterioration is mainly driven by the underlying trend; the seasonal effect is small. The current projection is off course for 78% by March 2027. Sustained favourable/adverse provider signals: 10/10.

LATEST · JULY 2026	OUTLOOK · AUGUST 2026	ACTUAL
75.9%	75.3%	
No archived pre-release forecast	80% range 74.2%–76.3%	Not yet released
		Off course · 78% by March 2027

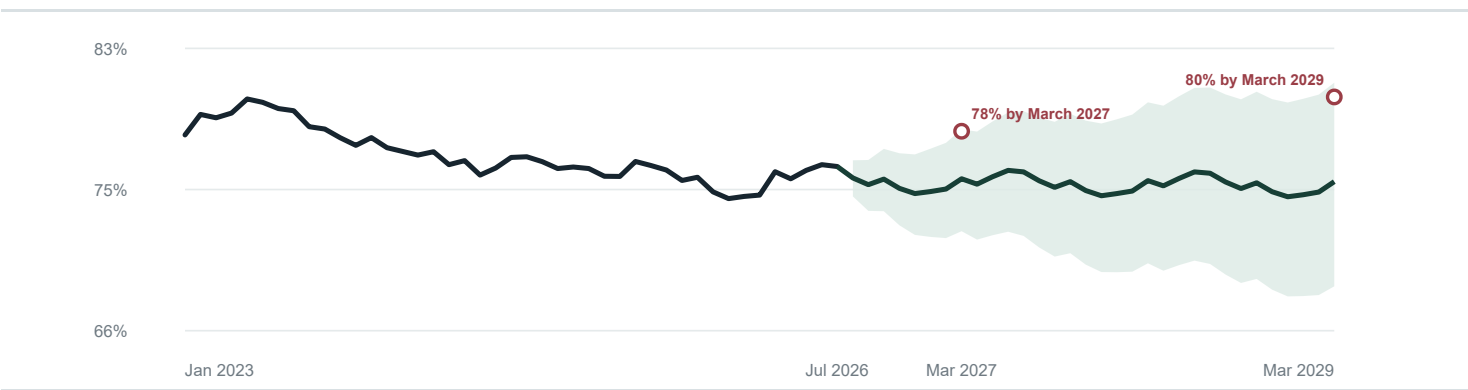
Recent performance and next release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



Benchmark: 80% by March 2029. 2.8pp below milestone

Data: NHS England community health services waiting lists. Targets: Medium Term Planning Framework interim target - Medium Term Planning Framework final target

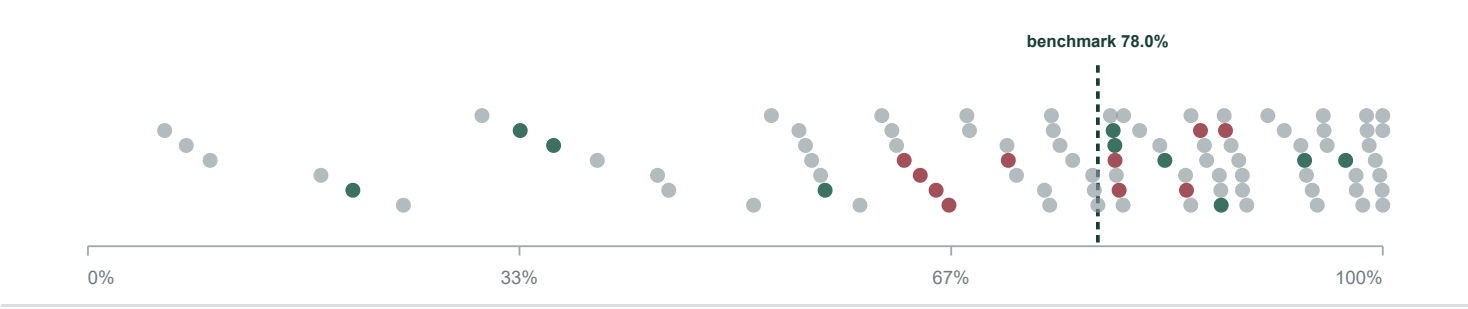
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 43 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 12 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 12 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

Community waiting list within 18 weeks

Distribution and trajectory watch · July 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



Trajectory watch

Signals show sustained departures from each provider's own archived outlook. A low performer can be improving, and a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the average gap across those six months.

48 providers assessed	10 sustained favourable	10 sustained adverse	28 without an active signal
Largest sustained favourable moves		Largest sustained adverse moves	
UNIVERSITY HOSPITALS PLYMOUTH NHS TRUST Latest 79.3% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest		FRIMLEY HEALTH NHS FOUNDATION TRUST Latest 85.9% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	
14.9pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH		16.5pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH	
YORK AND SCARBOROUGH TEACHING HOSPITALS NHS FOUNDATION TRUST Latest 56.9% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest		WHITTINGTON HEALTH NHS TRUST Latest 65.5% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	
14.3pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH		14.5pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH	
ACCELERATE CIC Latest 94.0% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest		BLACK COUNTRY HEALTHCARE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST Latest 71.1% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	
13.1pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH		10.7pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH	

Trajectory-watch rule. Six consecutive release surprises are compared with forecasts made before each release. A signal requires a material average gap, at least five of six months in the same direction, and the latest month confirming that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.

Community waits by service

England · July 2026

SERVICE MIX

Where waits over 18 weeks are concentrated

Services differ greatly in size. This ranks the published service categories by the number waiting over 18 weeks; it is a descriptive breakdown, not a forecast or provider comparison.

47

services with a reported total waiting list

43

services with complete published over-18-week bands

SERVICE	TOTAL WAITING	OVER 18 WEEKS	WITHIN 18 WEEKS
Community paediatric service	177,962	129,584	27.2%
Musculoskeletal service	442,807	71,863	83.8%
Therapy interventions: Speech and language	64,579	21,843	66.2%
Podiatry and podiatric surgery	109,759	15,046	86.3%
Nursing and Therapy support for LTCs: Continence/ colostomy	43,850	6,458	85.3%
Therapy interventions: Occupational therapy	21,156	6,186	70.8%
Therapy interventions: Dietetics	34,143	5,193	84.8%
Therapy interventions: Physiotherapy	42,449	4,932	88.4%
Audiology	19,133	4,859	74.6%
Therapy interventions: Speech and language	27,117	4,849	82.1%
Audiology	17,032	3,269	80.8%
Rehabilitation services (integrated)	44,016	3,191	92.8%
Therapy interventions: Physiotherapy	20,732	2,674	87.1%
Neurorehabilitation (multi-disciplinary)	13,597	2,482	81.7%
Therapy interventions: Dietetics	8,083	2,144	73.5%

Coverage and interpretation. Ranked by the published number waiting over 18 weeks. Complete over-18 bands were available for 43 of 47 services with a reported total. Rows with suppressed or incomplete bands are excluded from the ranking. The national headline on page 1 remains the authoritative aggregate. The within-18-week percentage is total waiting less all published over-18-week bands, divided by total. NHS England notes that the sum of weekly bands may not match the total where some providers were still collecting waits by weeks; reconciliation differences are retained in the QA outputs.